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Albert Zimmermann bei der Feier des 50jährigen Jubiläums
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Albert Zimmermann, Président d'honneur de la SIEPM
Requiescat in pace

AN INVENTORY OF MEDIEVAL COMMENTARIES ON PSEUDO-ARISTOTLE'S *PHYSIOGNOMONICA**

The reception history of texts on physiognomy in the Middle Ages remains a largely unexplored area of research: its full history still needs to be written, especially when it comes to the biggest player in the field, Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*. The text deals with physiognomy, the discipline in which one tries to derive a person's character traits from their outward appearance. This text, which is nowadays considered pseudepigraphic, was translated from Greek into Latin by Bartholomew of Messina under the reign of king Manfred of Sicily (1258-1266). Thanks in part to this Latin translation, there was a revival of interest in physiognomy in the Middle Ages. No fewer than 128 manuscripts have come down to the present, which makes it Bartholomew's most popular translation.

However, the scarce and partial source material available in modern editions hampers the study of the reception history of this Aristotelian text. Crucial information on the commentary tradition of the *Physiognomonica*, which adds much to our knowledge of how the text was read, interpreted and received by medieval scholars and philosophers, is still missing.¹ The present inventory

* This research was carried out within the framework of the project on the reception of Aristotle's *Physiognomonica* in the Middle Ages (project "The body as a mirror of the soul: an inquiry into the reception of the *Physiognomonica* in the Middle Ages and Renaissance" under the supervision of Pieter De Leemans and Russell Friedman).

¹ Worth mentioning are the major studies in the field of medieval physiognomy by J. AGRIMI, *Ingeniosa scientia nature: Studi sulla fisiognomica medievale* (Millennio medievale 36), Firenze 2002, and the many articles by Joseph Ziegler, of which I only mention some: J. ZIEGLER, "Text and Context: On the Rise of Physiognomic Thought in the Later Middle Ages", in *De Sion exhibit lex et verbum domini de Hierusalem*, ed. H. YITZHAK, Turnhout 2001, 159-82; J. ZIEGLER, "Médecine et physiognomonie du XIV^e au début du XVI^e siècle", in *Médiévales* 46 (2004), 89-108; J. ZIEGLER, "Philosophers and Physicians on the Scientific Validity of Latin Physiognomy, 1200-1500", in *Early Science and Medicine* 12 (2007), 285-312; J. ZIEGLER, "The Beginning of Medieval Physiognomy: The Case of Michael Scotus", in *Kulturtransfer und Hofgesellschaft im Mittelalter: Wissenskultur am sizilianischen und kastilianischen Hof im 13. Jahrhundert*, hrsg. v. G. GREBNER und J. FRIED (Wissenskultur und gesellschaftlicher Wandel 15), Berlin 2008, 299-319; J. ZIEGLER, "Physiognomy, Science, and Proto-Racism 1200-1500", in *The Origins of Racism in the West*, ed. M. ELIAV-FELDON, B. ISAAC and J. ZIEGLER, Cambridge 2009, 181-99. Both Agrimi and Ziegler faced the same problem regarding lack of materials as well. In their studies, they concentrate on the same medieval commentators, i.e. William of Spain, William of Mirica and John Buridan. Therefore, the disclosure of new commentaries will certainly shed new light on the development of medieval physiognomy. See also the forthcoming collective volume based on the interna-

aims to fill this gap, by listing all the medieval Latin commentaries that are written on Aristotle's *Physiognomonica* in the translation of Bartholomew of Messina, from the origin of the translation (around 1260) up to the end of the fifteenth century. The many physiognomic treatises that have no link with Aristotle's *Physiognomonica* are left aside.² The aim of this catalogue is to sketch a precise picture of the influence and reception of this Aristotelian text, and therefore the physiognomic tradition in its entirety.³

Methodology

Obviously, it would be preposterous to state that this inventory of commentaries is exhaustive. In the field of manuscript studies, presenting an exhaustive list is almost unattainable. Heuristic research is impeded by deficient library catalogues with undetailed descriptions of its collections. Furthermore, many collections have not yet been described in detail, which increases the chances of future discoveries of manuscripts or commentaries. Be that as it may, in listing the medieval commentaries—both ascribed and anonymous—I have tried to go through as much available material as possible.

The first indispensable work of reference was produced by C.H. Lohr, who for many years made catalogues of both medieval and Renaissance commentaries on Aristotelian treatises. This pioneering work had to be expanded, since Lohr only listed ascribed commentaries, whereas our aim is to list anonymous commentaries as well (which in our case amount to half of all commentaries). Moreover, many new manuscripts have been discovered since the publication of Lohr's inventories. Besides his efforts, we must mention the several repertoria, which treat all the medieval commentaries on Aristotelian works belonging to one specific library or country.⁴

tional workshop held in Leuven (November 9-10, 2016), *The Body as a Mirror of the Soul. Physiognomy from Antiquity to the Renaissance*, ed. L. DEVRIESE and P. DE LEEMANS, in which physiognomic thought and texts are studied in a diachronic perspective.

² This material will be published in L. DEVRIESE, "An Inventory of Anonymous Medieval Physiognomic Treatises" (forthcoming).

³ Similar attempts in the field of Aristotelian natural philosophical works include, among others, P. DE LEEMANS, "Medieval Latin Commentaries on Aristotle's *De Motu Animalium*. A contribution to the *Corpus commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum*", in *Recherches de Théologie et de Philosophie médiévales* 67 (2000), 272-360, and S. EBBESEN, C. THOMSEN THÖRNQUIST and V. DECAIX, "Questions on *De sensu et sensato*, *De memoria* and *De somno et vigilia*. A Catalogue", in *Bulletin de philosophie médiévale* 57 (2016), 59-115.

⁴ C.H. LOHR, *Latin Aristotle Commentaries I. Medieval Authors*, Firenze 2010-2013. This work collects all the previous articles which have appeared on this topic in the journal *Traditio*. C.H. LOHR, "Aristotelica Britannica", in *Theologie und Philosophie* 53 (1978), 79-101;

A second point of departure is the doctoral dissertation of J. Thomann, who studied the *Speculum physionomie*, a physiognomic work by Michele Savonarola (1442).⁵ As an addendum, he gives a list of physiognomic works written before the year 1500, which comprises all physiognomic works, thus not only those based on Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*. In spite of its wealth of material, this appendix also has several deficiencies: there is no clear order in the list, no chronology, and it does not allow one to detect mutual relationships or to make assumptions on the reception history of one specific physiognomic text. Besides, some manuscripts are categorized as separate treatises when in fact they are not, and others are categorized together as a single treatise when in fact they should be separated.

Some information extracted from these works had to be corrected. For example, some works are wrongly categorized: Lohr mentions in his catalogue a commentary of Rogerus Bourth.⁶ However, there is nothing in this text that indicates that it is a commentary on the Aristotelian text: Rogerus does not refer to the text; the text has a completely different structure; other explanations are given, etc. Moreover, some manuscripts were classified un-

IDEM, "Aristotelica Gallica: Bibliothecae M-Z", in *Theologie und Philosophie* 63 (1988), 79-121; IDEM, *Aristotelica Helvetica. Catalogus codicum latinorum in bibliothecis Confederationis Helveticae asservatorum quibus versiones expositionesque operum Aristotelis continentur*, Freiburg 1994; IDEM, "Aristotelica Hispalensia", in *Theologie und Philosophie* 50 (1975), 547-64. G.B. KOROLEC, *Repertorium commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliotheca olim Universitatis Pragensis nunc Státní knihovna ČSR vocata asservantur*, Wrocław-Warszawa-Kraków-Gdańsk 1977; M. MARKOWSKI, *Repertorium commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliotheca Amploniana Erfordiae asservantur*, Wrocław-Warszawa-Kraków-Gdańsk-Lódz 1987; M. MARKOWSKI et S. WLODEK, *Repertorium commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliotheca Iagellonica Cravociae asservantur*, Wrocław-Warszawa-Kraków-Gdańsk-Lódz 1974; M. MARKOWSKI, "Die Aristoteles-Kommentare in den mittelalterlichen Handschriften der Bibliothek des Metropolitankapitels zu Prag", in *Acta Mediaevalia. 30-ème anniversaire de la création de l'Institut de la Culture Médiévale*, éd. S. WIELGUS et S. MARKOWSKI, Lublin 1999, 227-70; IDEM, *Repertorium Commentariorum Medii Aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliothecis Wienae asservantur*, Wrocław-Warszawa-Kraków-Gdańsk-Lódz 1987; IDEM, *Repertorium commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum qui in bibliothecis autriacis asservantur*, Kraków 2008; A. PATTIN, *Repertorium Commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliothecis Belgicis asservantur*, Leuven-Leiden 1978; W. SEŃKO, *Repertorium Commentariorum Medii Aevi in Aristotelem Latinorum quae in Bibliothecis Publicis Parisiis asservantur*, Warszawa 1982; L. DE RIJK et O. WEIJERS, *Repertorium commentariorum medii aevi in Aristotelem latinorum quae in bibliothecis publicis Neerlandicis asservantur*, Amsterdam 1981; R. THOMSON, *Catalogue of medieval manuscripts of Latin commentaries on Aristotle in British libraries*, Turnhout 2011-2013.

⁵ J. THOMANN, *Studien zum Speculum physionomie des Michele Savonarola*, Zürich 1997.

⁶ LOHR, *Latin Aristotle Commentaries*, 145.

der the wrong commentator, whereas some manuscripts described as commentaries are in reality marginal annotations and not commentaries. Still, these works have provided an essential and extremely useful starting point for our catalogue. Its material is completed and updated with the material of our own heuristic research. This heuristic research has involved searching through all the library catalogues available at the Tabularium of the KU Leuven, which holds an extensive collection of reference works.⁷

I have opted to divide the inventory into two sections: the first shows the ascribed commentaries, using the time period in which the scholars lived and worked to set up a rough chronology. The second section shows the pseudepigraphic and anonymous commentaries. Since they are usually found in one manuscript only, they are mentioned alphabetically, depending on the city of the library which holds the manuscript.

The list of commentaries comprises the *incipit* and *explicit* of the work, followed by a list of manuscripts in which the text can be found (the manuscripts are mentioned in alphabetical order). Some of these manuscripts (†) have been consulted *in situ* or by means of digital images. The majority of the material remains to be published: only five of them have been (partially) edited.

There are different types of commentaries on the *Physiognomonica*, such as *questiones*, *expositiones* and *sententie cum questionibus*.⁸ Of the commentaries containing questions, I have added a list of those *questiones*, in order to give an impression of the type of questions that could be asked when reading the *Physiognomonica*, as well as to facilitate the study of development in content over time and place.

⁷ According to An Smets, librarian at the Tabularium, the library holds approximately 18.000 catalogues, all of which were browsed through for the current study.

⁸ See among others the following studies, which treat the medieval commentaries: F. DEL PUNTA, "The Genre of Commentaries in the Middle Ages and its Relation to the Nature and Originality of Medieval Thought", in *Was ist Philosophie im Mittelalter?*, hrsg. v. J.A. AERTSEN und A. SPEER (Miscellanea Mediaevalia 26), Berlin-New York 1998, 138-51; O. WEIJERS, "La structure des commentaires philosophiques à la Faculté des arts: quelques observations", in *Il commento filosofico nell'Occidente latino (secoli XIII-XV)*. Atti del colloquio Firenze-Pisa, 19-22 ottobre 2000, organizzato dalla SISMEL (Società Internazionale per lo Studio del Medioevo Latino) e dalla SISPM (Società Italiana per lo Studio del Pensiero Medievale), sotto l'egida della SIEPM, a cura di G. FIORAVANTI, C. LEONARDI e S. PERFETTI, Turnhout 2002, 17-41.

Some remarks on the questions of the *Physiognomonica*

The individual commentaries have not yet been studied *in extenso*, but it is possible to draw some provisional conclusions based on the content of the *questiones* commentaries. In the table below, I have assembled all the questions listed in this inventory, in order to give a clear picture of the questions dealt with in each commentary.

From this table, we can see the overall content of the questions: the general topics include the possibility of physiognomy as a discipline; on which signs one ought to rely; on the exact link between body and soul, and on the consequences of this link; and even on the structure of the hair and the significance of a swift or slow gait. A more detailed analysis shows that there is a lot of variation, and the questions can be asked in different ways. In turn, when we compare the questions with other traditions, e.g. the *questiones* on *De motu animalium*, we notice a higher degree of uniformity in the questions in the latter treatise.⁹

It is, however, possible to discern roughly two families of questions. On the one hand, we have the commentaries 1, 8, 9, 14, 22, and 24 (the numbers are taken from the inventory in this article): these seem to be inspired by the influential commentary by William of Aragon. This commentary, the first in our inventory and perhaps the first extant commentary on the *Physiognomonica*, asks the greatest number of questions, most of which are not taken up by later commentators. However, it is clear that some commentators rely on his commentary, since the phraseology of both question and answer is sometimes identical. On the other hand, we can discern a second group consisting of commentaries 3, 11, and 13 (i.e. the commentary by John Buridan and two anonymous commentaries inspired by him). In comparison with the first group, we notice that they put more emphasis on the signs to be used in physiognomy. Roughly half of the questions deal with the signs themselves, whereas the first group pays more attention to general theoretical questions. Besides these, we have two commentaries that do not fit neatly into the above groups (number 5 is more concerned with natural philosophy, and number 7 asks some basic questions).

In the table below, the questions are structured in the following manner: first, the more general questions are listed, followed by those dealing with specific signs, in order of appearance in the *Physiognomonica*. Minor discrepancies in formulation are not taken into account. It is, however, apparent

⁹ DE LEEMANS, "Medieval Latin Commentaries", 281.

that not all of the questions on the signs are directly inspired by the text of the *Physiognomonica*. Where there was a clear link with the pseudo-Aristotelian text, I have added the reference to the Bekker edition.¹⁰

Questiones

- | | | |
|----|--|-------------------|
| 1 | Utrum nobilior sit qui sola nobilitate parentum est nobilis, aut qui bonitate operationum propriarum fit nobilis. | 1,8,9,14,24 |
| 2 | Utrum speculativus nobilior sit activo. | 1,8,9,14 |
| 3a | Utrum phisonomia sit possibilis et utrum una. | 1,8,9,14 |
| 3b | Utrum per signa corporum exteriora potest haberi evidens iudicium de dispositione interiori | 3,13 |
| 3c | Utrum per signa corporis exteriora possint cognosci dispositiones et mores interiores. | 5 |
| 3d | Utrum ex actionibus exterioribus corporis poterimus induci ad cognoscendi interiora anime. | 7 |
| 3e | Utrum a physico vel medico possit per signa exteriora corporis humani sufficienter iudicare phisonomando mores et signa hominum. | 11 |
| 4 | Utrum ad diversitatem corporum sequitur diversitas animarum. | 1,8,9,14 |
| 5a | Utrum anime patiantur a motibus corporis. (805a1-4) | 1 |
| 5b | Utrum anime sequantur corpora. | 3,5,7,11,13,22,24 |
| 5c | Utrum anima patiatur a corpore. | 7 |
| 5d | Utrum anima per se sit passibilis passione corporis. | 8,9,14,24 |
| 6a | Utrum corpus patiatur ab anima. (805a5-8) | 1,8,9,14,22,24 |
| 6b | Utrum ex passionibus anime impeditur corpus. | 3 |
| 6c | Utrum ex passionibus anime corpus immutetur. | 11,13 |
| 7 | Utrum species ymaginata vel intellecta habet virtutem movendi et alterandi corpus. | 1,24 |
| 8 | Utrum aliquod animal possit esse vel sit quod habeat corpus alicuius animalis et animam alterius diversorum in specie. | 1,8,9,14,22 |
| 9 | Utrum ex dispositione et figura corporis possit anima talis vel talis argui. | 1 |
| 10 | Utrum secundum omnes phisonomizare contingat. | 1 |

¹⁰ ARISTOTELIS *Opera*, ed. I. BEKKER, Berlin 1831, 805a1-814b8. I am preparing a critical edition of the Latin *Physiognomonica* as part of my doctoral dissertation.

- 11 Utrum mores naturales, circa quod est phisonomia, debeant mutari propter mutationem temporis. 1,22
- 12 Utrum honor mutet mores naturales. 1
- 13 Non contingit cognoscere per signa phisonomie passiones artium vel scientiarum, utrum hoc habeat veritatem. 1,8,9,14
- 14 Utrum omnia individua eiusdem specie debeant habere eandem figuram. 1
- 15a Utrum duo homines possint omnino reperiri similes. 1,8,9,14
- 15b Utrum duo individua eiusdem specie possint esse eiusdem figure. 11,22
- 15c Utrum duo individua eiusdem specie possint esse eiusdem dispositionibus in moribus et figuris et coloribus et consimilibus. 22
- 16 Utrum filius debeat habere figuram patris aut matris. 1
- 17 Utrum in materia generationis sint motus ex parte matris. 1
- 18 Moribus apparentibus in facie [...] utrum tales mores ad unam causam sint reducibiles. 1
- 19 Utrum sit bonus modus phyzonomizandi per figuram. 3,5,11,13,22
- 20 Utrum modus phyzonomizandi per mores faciei sit bona. 3,11,13
- 21 Utrum signa corporis et signa anime possunt habere proportionem ad phisonomandum. 7
- 22 Utrum scientia phisonomie sit perficua. 7
- 23 Utrum animalia eiusdem specie different figuris sensitivis diversorum modorum et diversarum qualitaturn. 8,9,14
- 24 Utrum modus physionomiandi ex dispositionibus animalium alterius specie in hominibus sit possibilis. 8,9,14
- 25 Utrum de moribus naturalibus possit esse scientia. 22
- 26 Utrum ista scientia que dicitur physonomia sit naturalis vel moralis. 22
- 27 Utrum homines artifices et hoc quantum ad artes practicas activas et factivas et scientes et hoc quantum ad artes speculativas habentes possunt cognosci per signa physonomandi. 22
- 28 Utrum unius anime plures possint esse potentie. 1
- 29 Utrum membrorum dispositiones sint tales vel tales [...] propter tales vel tales virtutes anime vel potentias. 1
- 30a Queritur [...] quod septemtrionales fortes et duos habent capillos, meridiani vero habent mollem. (806b15-18) 1
- 30b Utrum pili molles significant timidum et duri fortem. 3,8,9,14,11,13
- 30c Utrum homines septemtrionales [...] sint audaciores et habentes pilos duriores hominibus meridionalibus. 3,8,9,11,13,14

- 31a Utrum caro dura naturaliter et habitus durus corporis significet hominem insensibilem, rudem et non ingeniosum. (806b21-23) 22
- 31b Utrum caro temperata mollis et dura significat bonam nativitatem. 22
- 32 Utrum habere magnas extremitates signum sit fortis. 22
- 33a Queritur [...] quod motus acuti vel veloces significant callidiorum et prudentiorum. (806b25-26) 1,8,9,14,22
- 33b Utrum ex motu tardo est iudicandum super intellectum mollem, debilitatem et timiditatem et ex motu veloci oppositum. 3,11,13
- 34a Utrum gravitas vocis sit signum fortitudinis et econverso de acuto respectu timiditatis. (806b26-27) 3,11,13,22
- 34b Utrum ex acuitate vocis in mulieribus sit iudicandum de earum timiditate. 13
- 35 Utrum rectitudo corporis et latitudo eius sit signum iracundi vel irascibilis. (808a19-20) 22
- 36 Utrum lippitudo oculorum et color album sint signa hominis parvi et misericordis, et utrum signa opposita sint signa hominis nocosi et austeri. (808a34-35) 22
- 37 Utrum habens superiora maiora sit sompnolentus. (808b7) 22
- 38 Utrum habentes superiora et maiora curviora et carnosiora significant bone memorie. (808b9-10) 22
- 39 Utrum mas et femina diversificentur in dispositionibus corporis propter diversitatem potentialium in anima vel propter diversitatem complexionis corporis vel materia ex qua habent generari. 1
- 40a Utrum femina debeat habere subtiliora crura masculo et debiliora. (809b4-11) 1
- 40b Utrum femina sit frigidior, timidior, iniustior et minoris capitis masculo. 8,9,14
- 40c Utrum masculus sit fortior fortitudine corporali ipsa femella et habens grossiora membra et etiam melior secundum omnes virtutes. 22
- 41 Utrum ex magnitudine et eminentia oculorum sit iudicandum super stoliditatem. (811b24-25) 3,11,13
- 42 Utrum parvitas et profunditas oculorum sit signum boni et acuti visus. 3,11,13
- 43 Utrum magna frons significat tardum et pigrum. (811b29-30) 3,11,13
- 44 Utrum ex magnitudine et longitudine aurium sit iudicandum super stoliditatem. 3,11,13
- 45 Utrum ex magnitudine et amplitudine narium sit iudicandum super irascibilitate. 3,13

- 46 Utrum ex magnitudine oris sit iudicandum super homine vorace et guloso. 3,13
- 47a Utrum color niger significet timorem. (812b1-2) 1,8,9,14
- 47b Utrum color album sit signum timiditatis. (812b4-5) 7,13
- 47c Utrum nigredo attestatur super melancholiam et partitatem. 7,13
- 47d Utrum color album significat hominem luxuriosum. 22
- 48 Utrum parvi sint prudentiores magnis. 8,9,14
- 49a Utrum ex scientia et iudiciis astrorum potest haberi evidens iudicium de physonomia et moribus hominum. 3
- 49b Utrum celum agat in intellectum et voluntatem. 8,9,14
- 50 Utrum potentie vegetative et potentie secundum locum motive non exercent operationes suas sine organo et ideo huiusmodi operationes non sunt solum ipsius anime sed sunt simul anime et corporis. 5
- 51 Utrum corpora colorata vel luminosa mediante medio diafano aliquid agant in visum. 5
- 52 Utrum perspicuum sit subiectum coloris, ita quod quilibet color insit subiectum perspicuo subiective. 5

ASCRIBED COMMENTARIES

1. GUILIELMUS DE HISPANIA, *Summa supra phisonomiam* (1260-1295)

Incipit: *Sicut dicit Philosophus primo sue Rethorice nobilitas est genti et civitati sui iuris antiquos esse presides, in quo Philosophus optime innuit nobilitatis originem et formam qualitatis ipsius. Est enim unusquisque sui iuris antiquus preses qui secundum sui antiqua dominus suarum operationum existit.* (ed. VAL NAVAL, 119)

Explicit: *Luna dat natum vagabundum nullius servitii, cum facie rotunda, stature mediocris, et habet unum oculum maiorem altero; vel breviter dicam semper habet ex aliquo casu oculos inequales. Hec sint dicta pregustationis gratia; qui vero in istis profundius considerare voluerit ad astrorum scientiam transferat mentem suam.* (ed. VAL NAVAL, 383-85)

Colophon: *Explicit summa magistri Guillelmi Hispani supra phisonomiam Aristotelis cum questionibus eiusdem.* (ed. VAL NAVAL, 385)

Manuscripts:

1. Basel, Universitätsbibliothek, A.X.131, f. 112rv, year 1454-58 [only one part]
2. Cambridge, Peterhouse Library, Ms. 143, ff. 103v-113v, 13th-14th c. [= II 25v-36v]

3. † Città del Vaticano, Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Cod. Barb. lat. 309, ff. 69v-80v, 14th c.
4. † Città del Vaticano, Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Cod. Ross. 569, ff. 206r-213v, 14th c.
5. † Città del Vaticano, Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Cod. Urb. lat. 1392, ff. 46r-65v, year 1441 [attributed to Petrus Hispanus]¹¹
6. Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., Q 306, ff. 47r-61v, end of 13th – beginning of 14th c. [attrib. to Thomas Aquinas]
7. Firenze, Biblioteca Nazionale Centrale, Panciatich. 132, f. 54rv [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]¹²
8. Graz, Universitätsbibliothek, Ms. 976, ff. 47v-49r, 15th c. [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]
9. Graz, Universitätsbibliothek, Ms. 1121, ff. 114v-115r, 14th c. [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]
10. Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 1197, f. 72rv [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]
11. Lüneburg, Ratsbücherei, Ms. Miscell. D 4° 46, ff. 61v-62v, 14th c. [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]
12. Melk, Stiftsbibliothek, Cod. 1858, ff. 163r-185v, 13th c.
13. Milano, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, H.199 inf., ff. 45r-54v, 14th c.
14. Milano, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, R.34 sup., ff. 55r-75r, 16th c.
15. Milano, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, R.36 sup., ff. 55r-74r, year 1309 [attributed to Petrus de Alvernia]
16. München, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 11322, ff. 49r-56v, 14th c.
17. München, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 16456, ff. 142v-144r, year 1414 [attr. to Aegidius Romanus] [only epilogue: *cum in virtute superiorum et incorruptibilium...*]
18. Paris, Bibliothèque Mazarine, Ms. 3485, ff. 299r-311v, beginning of the 14th c.
19. † Paris, Bibliothèque Nationale de France, Ms. lat. 16089, ff. 244r-257r, 13th-14th c.

¹¹ On this incorrect attribution, see J.F. MEIRINHOS, “A atribuição a Petrus Hispanus das *Sententie super libro de physonomia* de Guillelmus Hispanus, no manuscrito Vaticano, Urb. lat. 1392”, in *Mediaevalia. Textos e Estudos* 7-8 (1995), 329-59.

¹² Together with some other manuscripts (Graz, Kraków, Lüneburg and München), this text has been incorrectly attributed to Aegidius Romanus (see J. EASTMAN, “Die Werke des Aegidius Romanus”, in *Augustiniana* 44 [1994], 209-31), while in reality it is the last chapter of William of Aragon’s commentary.

20. † Paris, Bibliothèque Nationale de France, Ms. lat. 16158, ff. 146r-161v, 14th c.
21. † Paris, Bibliothèque Nationale de France, Ms. lat. 16170, f. 33v, s. 14th c. [fragment]
22. † Praha, Národní Knihovna České Republiky, Cod. IV.H.6 (cat. 770), ff. 95v-113r, 14th c.
23. Ravenna, Biblioteca Classense, Ms. lat. 409, ff. 120r-126r, 14th c.
24. Wien, Österreichische Nationalbibliothek, Cod. Pal. lat. 4753, ff. 163r-189v, 14th-15th c.
25. Wolfenbüttel, Herzog-August-Bibliothek, Cod. Guelf. 18.31 Aug. 4°, ff. 240r-251v, 15th c.

Edition: P. VAL NAVAL, *Estudio, Edición Crítica, Traducción y Comentario de la Summa supra phisonomiam de Guillermo de Aragón (c. 1300)*, Universidad de Zaragoza [Doctoral dissertation] 2006. The manuscripts number 1, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 14 and 17 are not mentioned by Val Naval in the edition.

Text: William of Spain lived at the end of the thirteenth and beginning of the fourteenth century. He studied medicine and was a physician at the court of Aragon, before he was called to the court of Mallorca. Later, he received the title of *magister* at the Faculty of Medicine at the University of Montpellier, where he taught in 1335.¹³ He must have travelled in the Languedoc region, since he indicates in the commentary that he knows French and Provençal.

Val Naval argues that the audience of the commentary was probably not Spanish (he gives additional information on a region in Spain, while Narbonne is left without extra information), which gives the impression that the commentary was written in France, in Montpellier. It must be situated between 1260 and 1295.¹⁴ The commentary is written in the literary genre of *interpretatio cum questionibus*, which connects the traditional *expositio/sententia* with *questiones*.¹⁵ See the edition of Val Naval for an extensive presentation and study of this commentary, which was very influential in the

¹³ VAL NAVAL, *Estudio, Edición Crítica*, 51.

¹⁴ VAL NAVAL, *Estudio, Edición Crítica*, 39-41; GUILLMUS DE ARAGONIA, *De nobilitate animi*, ed. W.D. PADEN et M. TROVATO (Harvard Studies in Medieval Latin 2), Cambridge 2012, XIII.

¹⁵ Val Naval gives an extensive survey of the structure and content of the text, see VAL NAVAL, *Estudio, Edición Crítica*, 78-82. For more information on this literary genre, see O. WEIJERS, "Un type de commentaire particulier à la Faculté des arts: la *sententia cum questionibus*", in *La tradition vive. Mélanges d'histoire des textes en l'honneur de Louis Holtz*, éd. P. LARDET (Bibliologia 20), Paris-Turnhout 2003, 211-22.

later physiognomic tradition. It was an authority for the later commentaries, and extracts of this commentary can be found in some marginal glosses on the *Physiognomonica*.¹⁶

- (q.1) Utrum nobilior sit qui sola nobilitate parentum est nobilis, aut qui bonitate operationum propriarum fit nobilis.
- (q.2) Utrum speculativus nobilior sit active.
- (q.3) Utrum phisonomia sit possibilis et utrum una.
- (q.4) Utrum ad diversitatem corporum sequitur diversitas animarum.
- (q.5) Utrum anime patiantur a motibus corporis.
- (q.6) Utrum corpus patiat ab anima.
- (q.7) Utrum species ymaginata vel intellecta habet virtutem movendi et alterandi corpus.
- (q.8) Utrum aliquod animal possit esse vel sit quod habeat corpus alicuius animalis et animam alterius diversorum in specie.
- (q.9) Utrum ex dispositione et figura corporis possit anima talis vel talis argui.
- (q.10) Utrum secundum omnes phisonomizare contingat.
- (q.11) Utrum mores naturales, circa quod est phisonomia, debeant mutari propter mutationem temporis.
- (q.12) Utrum honor mutet mores naturales.
- (q.13) Non contingit cognoscere per signa phisonomie passiones artium vel scientiarum, utrum hoc habeat veritatem.
- (q.14) Utrum omnia individua eiusdem specie debeant habere eandem figuram.
- (q.15) Utrum duo homines possint omnino reperiri similes.
- (q.16) Utrum filius debeat habere figuram patris aut matris.
- (q.17) Utrum in materia generationis sint motus ex parte matris.
- (q.18) Moribus apparentibus in facie [...] utrum tales mores ad unam causam sint reducibiles.
- (q.19) Queritur ergo de hoc quod Philosophus dicit quod septentrionales fortes et duros habent capillos, meridiani vero habent mollem.
- (q.20) Consequenter queritur de hoc quod dicit quod motus acuti vel veloces significant callidiorem et prudentiorem.
- (q.21) Utrum unius anime plures possint esse potentie.

¹⁶ See L. DEVRIESE, “Physiognomy in Context: Marginal Annotations in the Manuscripts of the *Physiognomonica*”, in *Recherches de Théologie et Philosophie médiévales* 84.1 (2017), 107-41.

(q.22) Utrum membrorum dispositiones sint tales vel tales [...] propter tales vel tales virtutes anime vel potentias.

(q.23) Utrum mas et femina diversificentur in dispositionibus corporis propter diversitatem potentiarum in anima vel propter diversitatem complexionis corporis vel materia ex qua habent generari.

(q.24) Utrum femina debeat habere subtiliora crura masculo et debiliora.

(q.25) Utrum color niger significet timorem.

2. Guilelmus de Mirica, *Opusculum in libellum phisonomie Aristotelis* (1342-1352)

Incipit: (Dedication) *Sanctissimo in Christo patri ac domino domino Clementi sacrosancte romane et universalis ecclesie summo pontifici Guilelmus dictus de Mirica artistarum ne dicat magistrorum in artibus minimus cum humili sua recomendatione devota pedum oscula beatorum.* (Ms. Oxford)

(Commentary) *Boecius tertio De consolatione philosophye loquens de felicitate, sic dicit: mentibus inquit hominum est inserta veri boni cupiditas sed ad falsa eos devius error abducit, hoc Boecius. Istud autem verum bonum sive felicitas saltem mundana de qua philosophi sunt locuti.* (Ms. Oxford)

Explicit: *Sed immediate dicta lectura videtur melior, quia est generalior ista includens, quia per ista signa non solum apparet quis sit naturaliter sensatus et intelligens, sed universaliter omnes affectiones alie et dispositiones quecumque. Et in hoc terminatur tertia distinctio istius opusculi, et per consequens totum opusculum.* (Ms. Oxford)

Manuscripts:

1. † Oxford, Bodleian Library, Ms. Canon. Misc. 350, ff. 1r-217v, end of 15th c.
2. † Roma, Biblioteca Universitaria Alessandrina, Ms. lat. 81, ff. 1r-95v, 13th-14th c.

Text: William of Mirica, possibly of German origin, dedicated his work to pope Clement VI (1342-1352). His model was definitely William of Aragon, whom he at times takes over almost verbatim.¹⁷ However, in general, William of Mirica is more extensive in his elaborations, quotes other authorities, and broaches new subjects.

¹⁷ See AGRIMI, *Ingeniosa scientia nature*, 141-55 on William of Mirica.

3. Ioannes Buridanus (1300-1358), *Questiones super librum De Physonomia*

Incipit: *Circa librum Physonomie Aristotilis queritur primum utrum per physonomiam potest haberi aliquod certum iudicium de moribus hominum. Et arguitur primo quod non, quia dispositiones exteriores hominum mutantur continue, quamvis quandoque non mutantur mores.* (Mss. Oxford and Augsburg)

Circa librum de physonomia Aristotelis primo queritur utrum per signa corporum exteriora potest haberi evidens iudicium de dispositione interiori, et arguitur primo quod non, quia multe dispositiones intrinsece sunt immutabiles sicut patet per experientiam. (Mss. Erfurt and Gent)

Explicit: *Et ideo ad hoc valent orationes et sunt mala et bona, nec homo precognoscens futura assimilatur Deo quantum ad equalitatem, quia Deus omnia presentia preterita et futura cognoscit intuitive et in infinitum perfectius quam aliquis homo potest cognoscere et etiam infinitum planeta.*

Colophon: *Expliciunt questiones physionomie Aristotilis edite per magistrum Iohanem Buridanum, cuius anima requiescat in pace.* (Ms. Oxford)

Manuscripts:

1. † Augsburg, Staats- und Stadtbibliothek, 4° Cod. 220, ff. 10r-37v, 14th c.
2. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 342, ff. 16r-23v, 14th c.
3. † Gent, Universiteitsbibliotheek, Hs. 72, ff. 374r-395v, 15th c.
4. † Oxford, Bodleian Library, Ms. Canon. Misc. 422, ff. 111r-128r, 15th c.

Edition: J. Biard and C. Grellard are preparing an edition of this commentary by Buridan.

Text: Within the well-studied and extensive oeuvre of the famous medieval philosopher John Buridan, we can find one topic which has hardly received any attention: his natural philosophical commentaries on Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*.¹⁸ As a consequence of the general lack of knowledge on this topic, when scholars speak of Buridan's physiognomic work, they often mention manuscripts without having any notion of the exact content of the manuscript and commentary. Previous scholars were aware of the fact that there were two different types of commentaries (i.e. *questiones* and *expo-*

¹⁸ Recent studies on Buridan's natural philosophical works comprise: M. STANEK, *Jana Burydana. Quaestiones super Parva naturalia Aristotelis. Edycja krytyczna i analiza historyczno-filozoficzna*, unpublished Ph.D. thesis, University of Silesia, Katowice 2015; C. BENEDEUCE, *Natural Philosophy and Medicine in John Buridan, with an edition of Buridan's Quaestiones de Secretis Mulierum*, unpublished Ph.D. thesis, Università di Pisa and Radboud Universiteit Nijmegen 2017.

sitio), but they do not specify which manuscripts contain which, and often their categorizations are incorrect.¹⁹ For this inventory, I have been able to discover new manuscripts and to distinguish three different commentaries (n.3-5).

The four manuscripts of the *questiones* commentary in this entry have never been put together under one category. The manuscripts of Erfurt and Gent were considered as containing a different text, for the very simple reason that they have a different *incipit*. However, a close study reveals that only the first question of this commentary is different; from the second question onwards, the text is similar in all four manuscripts (some writing mistakes, inversions, or differences in word use excepted). The manuscript of Augsburg, a newly discovered witness of this commentary, is followed by a poem about a king.

- (q.1) (Erfurt-Gent) Primo queritur utrum per signa corporum exteriora potest haberi evidens iudicium de dispositione interiori. / (Oxford-Augsburg) Utrum per physionomiam potest habere aliquod certum iudicium de moribus hominum.
- (q.2) Queritur secundo utrum anime sequantur corpora sic quod ad dispositionem diversam corporum in specie humana sequantur diverse dispositiones animarum et operationes earundem.
- (q.3) Queritur tertio utrum ex passionibus anime impeditur corpus.
- (q.4) Queritur quarto utrum sit bonus modus phyzonominandi per figuram.
- (q.5) Queritur quinto utrum modus phyzonomizandi per mores faciei sit bona.
- (q.6) Queritur utrum pili molles significant timidum et duri fortem.
- (q.7) Queritur utrum gravitas vocis sit signum fortitudinis et econverso de acuto respectu timiditatis.
- (q.8) Queritur utrum ex motu tardo est iudicandum super intellectum mollem, debilitatem et timiditatem et ex motu veloci oppositum.
- (q.9) Queritur utrum magna frons significat tardum et pigrum.
- (q.10) Queritur utrum ex magnitudine et eminentia oculorum sit iudicandum super stoliditatem.
- (q.11) Queritur utrum parvitas et profunditas oculorum sit signum boni et acuti visus.
- (q.12) Queritur utrum ex magnitudine et longitudine aurium sit iudicandum super stoliditate.

¹⁹ See among others LOHR, *Latin Aristotle Commentaries*, 262-63.

(q.13) Queritur utrum ex magnitudine et amplitudine narium sit iudicandum super irascibilitate.

(q.14) Queritur utrum ex magnitudine oris sit iudicandum super homine vorace et guloso.

(q.15) Queritur utrum ex scientia et iudiciis astrorum potest haberi evidens iudicium de physonomia et moribus hominum.

4. Ioannes Buridanus, *Expositio super librum De Physionomia*

Incipit: '*Quoniam anime sequuntur corpora*'. Iste liber continet duos tractatus. Primus ostendit in generali physonomiam esse possibilem, et cum hoc diversos modos physonomisandi. Secundus ostendit per quem modum et qualia signa debemus physonomizare; secundus ibi '*physonomia*'. (Ms. Erfurt)

Explicit: *signa signis certiora minus certis potest prudens indagator investigare dispositionem anime ex dispositione corporis, quia mirabili et substantiali compositione gloriosus Deus composuit, qui sit benedictus in secula seculorum.* (Ms. Erfurt)

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 342, ff. 24r-29v, 14th c.
2. † Gent, Universiteitsbibliotheek, Hs. 72, ff. 366r-373v, 15th c. [misses final part of the commentary]

Edition: This literal commentary by Buridan is being edited by L. Devriese.

Text: Generally, an *expositio* on physiognomy is ascribed to John Buridan, and two manuscripts of Erfurt are connected to this treatise.²⁰ I was able to find two other manuscripts that could be connected to this treatise—one of Augsburg and one of Gent (see n.6 of this inventory). It must be noted that these four manuscripts do not contain the exact same text, but they can be divided into two groups. On the one hand, we have the group of manuscripts Erfurt and Gent; on the other, the manuscripts Augsburg and Erfurt. While

²⁰ The catalogue of the Erfurt manuscript (W. SCHUM, *Beschreibendes Verzeichniss der Amplonianischen Handschriften-Sammlung zu Erfurt*, Berlin 1887, 570-71), LOHR, *Medieval Latin Aristotle Commentaries*, 262-63 (although he mixes up some different commentaries); E. FARAL, "Jean Buridan: Notes sur les manuscrits", in *Archives d'Histoire Doctrinale et Littéraire du Moyen Âge* 15 (1946), 1-53; B. MICHAEL, *Johannes Buridan: Studien zu seinem Leben, seinen Werken und zur Rezeption seiner Theorien im Europa des Späten Mittelalters*, Berlin 1985, 783-84 and AGRIMI, *Ingeniosa scientia nature*, 155 consider this a commentary by John Buridan. Thorndike, on the other hand, adds a question mark to the name of Buridan and is uncertain about the authorship (L. THORNDIKE and P. KIBRE, *A Catalogue of Incipits of Medieval Scientific Writings in Latin*, London 1963, 787.6).

J. Agrimi and C.H. Lohr²¹ consider these to be the same text, they are not. Throughout the text, the treatises have different phraseology, although they display similarities in structure. In turn, the end of the text is the same in both versions. I believe that one version is an adaption or revision of the other, since they are closely related to each other in content. It seems that they offer the same content, only in a different vocabulary. Moreover, it seems that the revision stopped towards the end of the text, since from the title '*quicumque autem metaphrenon*' onwards, they offer the exact same text. Further research is needed to disentangle the exact relationship of the two sets of manuscripts.

The Erfurt 342, Gent, and Augsburg manuscripts contain the *questiones* of Buridan as well (n.3 of this inventory).

5. Pseudo-Ioannes Buridanus, *Questiones super librum De Physonomia*

Incipit: *Circa parvos libros naturales queritur utrum potentie vegetative et potentie secundum locum motive non exercent operationes suas sine organo, et ideo huiusmodi operationes non sunt solum ipsius anime sed sunt simul anime et corporis. Et propter hoc oportet esse de huiusmodi operationibus duplicem determinationem: una est determinatio de potentiis, operationibus et passionibus anime pro quanto se tenent ex parte anime* (Ms. Vaticano 11575)

Explicit: *Et propter hoc frequenter videmus quod canes qui magis assimulantur lupis etiam magis habent mores lupinos, et ita de hiis qui assimulantur vulpibus habent mores vulpinos. Ad rationes patet quia intentio Aristotelis fuit solum improbare modum phisonomandi per figuram tantum vel per aliquid aliud tantum unum signum, sed tantum figuram convenientius cum aliis partium, ut dictum est, certum est signum.* (Ms. Vaticano 11575)

Colophon: *Expliciunt questiones parvorum naturalium de phisonomia.* (Ms. Vaticano 11575)

Expliciunt quedam questiones circha parvos libros naturales cum quibusdam questionibus circha phisonomia ad honorem Dei. (Ms. Vaticano 2880)

Manuscripts:

1. † Città del Vaticano, Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Cod. Vat. lat. 2880, ff. 87r-89v, 15th c.
2. † Città del Vaticano, Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana, Cod. Vat. lat. 11575, ff. 88r-91v, 14th-15th c.

Text: This commentary is not an independent commentary on pseudo-

²¹ Lohr, *Latin Aristotle Commentaries*, 38.

Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*, but on the *Parva naturalia*. However, some questions on physiognomy have been added, which closely resemble the questions of other commentaries in this inventory. Both Vatican manuscripts contain texts that are attributed to Buridan, but the questions on the *Physiognomonica* do not contain an explicit attribution. According to B. Michael, the text is a compilation of authentic questions by Buridan.²²

(q.1) Utrum potentie vegetative et potentie secundum locum motive non exercent operationes suas sine organo et ideo huiusmodi operationes non sunt solum ipsius anime sed sunt simul anime et corporis.

(q.2) Utrum corpora colorata vel luminosa mediante medio diafano aliquid agant in visum.

(q.3) Utrum perspicuum sit subiectum coloris, ita quod quilibet color insit subiectum perspicuo subiective.

(q.4) Utrum per signa corporis exteriora possint cognosci dispositiones et mores interiores.

(q.5) Utrum anime sequantur corpora ita quod secundum alterationem corporum fiat alteratio animarum.

(q.6) Utrum sit bonus modus phisonomizare per figuram.

6. Ioannes Velstede Saxo (?),

Expositio super librum de physiognomia Aristotelis (1355)

Incipit: '*Quoniam et anime sequuntur corpora*'. Iste liber de phisonomia Aristotelis in quo docet cognoscere passiones anime per dispositiones membrorum exteriorum corporis dividitur in duos tractatus, quia in primo probat per phisionomiam posse fieri verum iudicium et ostendit in generali quomodo et per quam signam sit physonomiandum.

Explicit: *signa signis certiora minus certis potest prudens indagator investigare dispositionem anime ex dispositione corporis, quia mirabili et substantiali compositione gloriosus Deus composuit qui* (Ms. Augsburg) *regnat in perpetuum /* (Ms. Erfurt) *sit benedictus in secula seculorum.*

Colophon: *Explicit fisionomia lecta Parisius per magistrum Johannem Saxonem Gisilberti filii Ade de Brunswip anno domini 1355 in vigilia beati Mathie apostoli finita etc.* (Ms. Augsburg)

*Expliciunt scripta super librum physionomie Aristotelis. Expliciunt questiones utiles et bone a reverendo magistro Buridano Parisius pertractate, ab Amplonio Ratincq difficulter notate, quoniam exemplar studentium erat incorrectum.*²³ (Ms. Erfurt)

²² MICHAEL, *Johannes Buridan: Studien*, 786-88.

²³ It is remarkable that the colophon speaks of *questiones*, while the manuscript contains an *expositio*. Moreover, it seems to be written in a different handwriting. It is possible that this

Manuscripts:

1. † Augsburg, Staats- und Stadtbibliothek, 4° Cod. 220, ff. 1r-9v, 14th c.
2. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 299, ff. 158r-165v, 14th c.

Text: The attribution of this commentary on the *Physiognomonica* is doubtful. In the colophon of the manuscript of Erfurt the name of Buridanus is mentioned, though in previous catalogues it was considered as a work of pseudo-Buridanus. A manuscript of Augsburg has been newly discovered, which hands down the exact same text, but with an attribution to Ioannes Saxo, mentioning that it was written in Paris in 1355.

For the link between this version with Buridan's *expositio*, see n.4 of this inventory.

7. Goszwinus,

Reportata super Aristotelis tractatum de physiognomia (1346)

Incipit: *Aristoteles scribit secundo De animalibus: debemus inspicere formas creaturarum et amirari artificem, qui creavit eas. Istam propositionem possumus declarare tripliciter.*

Explicit: *Formis in quibus sunt plurime sapientie superapparentia, i.e. per quem signum apparentie poterimus investigare habilitatem et inclinationem corporum super scientias et virtutes.*

Colophon: *Expliciunt reportata a magistro Gosswino super phisionomiam Aristotelis, completa in festo Sancti Bartholomei apostoli circa horam et pulsum vespere per manus magistri pro tunc existente rectore puorum in Dylingen M trecenteno xl sex addimus illis.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Wien, Österreichische Nationalbibliothek, Cod. 5500, ff. 85r-112v, 15th c.

Text: This text is a transcription of a lecture of master Goszwin of around 1346.²⁴

is a mistake, especially since the colophon of the following text—questions of Buridan(!) on *De secretis mulierum*— is the same: “*Expl. quest. bone a reverendo mag. Buridano pertracte ab Amplonio Rensie in Gallia super secr. mul. not. diff. quo. exempl. stud. er. incorr.*”, see W. SCHUM, *Beschreibendes Verzeichniss der Amplonianischen Handschriften-Sammlung zu Erfurt*, Berlin 1887, 539. The manuscript contains other treatises as well (*questiones*) of Nicole Oresme. See also BENEDEUCE, *Natural Philosophy and Medicine* on this topic.

²⁴ It is possible that Goszwinus is the same person as Goszwin de Hueven, see E. WICKERSHEIMER, *Dictionnaire biographique des médecins en France au Moyen Âge*, Genève 1979, 95.

- (q.1) Utrum signa corporis et signa anime possunt habere proportionem ad phisonomandum.
- (q.2) Utrum ex actionibus exterioribus corporis poterimus induci ad cognoscendi interiora anime.
- (q.3) Utrum anime sequuntur corpora.
- (q.4) Utrum scientia phisionomie sit perficua.
- (q.5) Utrum anima patiatu a corpore.
- (q.6) Utrum color album sit signum timiditatis.
- (q.7) Utrum nigredo attestatur super melancholiam et partitatem.

8. Paulus de Worczyn (1380-1426),
Questiones disputate super de physiognomia Aristotelis

Incipit: *Circa initium physiognomie Aristotelis queritur utrum ars physiognomizandi sit possibilis. Ex littera elicitur quod sic, quia philosophus edidit nobis arte phizonomandi*

Explicit: *Qui sua caritate dignatus est nos opitulare et nobis bonum donare principium melius medium et optimum finem. Amen.*

Colophon: *Explicit disputata reverendi magistri Pauli de Worcin super Parva Naturalia fideliter per ipsum disputata in studio Cracoviensi et conscripta per Nicola Spiczmer.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 2073, ff. 103v-115v, 15th c.

Text: This commentary by Paulus de Worczyn (which is the oldest of the three commentaries that are preserved in manuscripts of Cracow—see n.9 and 14 of this inventory) is highly similar to the following commentaries by Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega and by an anonymous author. Although the texts are attributed to different authors, they offer almost the same version, with some redactions at the level of vocabulary, the use of sources, and the structure of the text.

- (q.1) Utrum ars physiognomiandi sit possibilis.
- (q.2) Utrum ille qui est nobilis sola nobilitate parentum, sit nobilior illo qui est nobilis nobilitate bonarum operationum.
- (q.3) Utrum speculativus sit nobilior active.
- (q.4) Utrum celum agat in intellectum et voluntatem.
- (q.5) Utrum ad diversitatem corporum sequitur diversitas animarum.
- (q.6) Utrum anima per se sit passibilis passione corporis.
- (q.7) Utrum corpus patitur ab anima.

- (q.8) Utrum possibile sit esse aliquod animal quod habeat corpus unius animalis et animam alterius animalis diversam specie.
- (q.9) Utrum animalia eiusdem speciei differunt figuris sensitivis diversorum modorum et diversarum qualitatuum.
- (q.10) Utrum duo homines possunt reperiri omnino similes.
- (q.11) Utrum modus physionomiandi ex dispositionibus animalium alterius speciei in hominibus sit possibilis.
- (q.12) Utrum contingit per signa physionomie cognoscere passiones artium et scientiarum.
- (q.13) Utrum pili molles significant timidum et pili duri fortem.
- (q.14) Utrum velociores in motu sint prudentiores hiis qui tarde moventur.
- (q.15) Utrum color niger significet timorem.
- (q.16) Utrum parvi sint prudentiores magnis.
- (q.17) Utrum femina sit frigidior, timidior, iniustior et minoris capitis masculo.

9. Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega (†1474),
Questiones disputate super de physionomia

Incipit: *Circa initium Physionomie Aristotelis, utrum ars physionomiandi sit possibilis, dicatur ex textu quod sic, quia Philosophus tradidit nobis artem physionomiandi et plures alii auctores, sicut Avicenna, Rhases, Philemon.* (ed. GARBACZOWA, 131)

Explicit: *Tertium dubium: quare semper incedit tecta? Dicatur, quod ideo, quia debet esse subiecta viro, sicut alia omnia animalia debent esse subiecta Deo, cui laus et honor per infinita secula seculorum. Amen.* (ed. GARBACZOWA, 164)

Colophon: *O pie Ihesu Christe, da, ut possideat vitam eternam scriptor iste etcetera. Expliciunt Parva naturalia per reverendum magistrum Nicolaum de Brega sacre theologie doctorem in studio Cracoviensi compilata, sub commutatione hiemali per Iohannem de Kleparz scripta. Expliciunt Parva naturalia.* (ed. GARBACZOWA, 164)

Manuscripts:

1. Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 2086, ff. 299r-312r, 15th c.

Edition: M. GARBACZOWA, "Mikolaja Z Brzegu Komentarz do *De Physionomia* Pseudo-Arystotelesa w Zbiorach Rekopismiennych Biblioteki Jagiellońskiej", in *Studia mediewistyczne* 19.2 (1978), 127-64.

Text: In the introduction to the edition, it is mentioned that all the commentaries of Cracow are influenced by one another. The commentary of Paulus

de Worczyn is the oldest and was used as a direct source and model for Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega, although Tempelfeld de Brega's version became more popular in the university milieu of Krakau in the fifteenth century. Tempelfeld de Brega changed the text of de Worczyn mainly in structure, and added more references to sources. Texts coming afterwards can be seen as recycling or copying Tempelfeld de Brega's text.

For the questions of this commentary, see n.8, Paulus de Worczyn. The exact set of questions is taken over.

ANONYMOUS COMMENTARIES

10. Anonymus Aberystwyth, *In Physiognomia*

Incipit: *Circa initium huius. Ex quo scientia presentis libri subordinatur philosophie naturali questio: primo videndum est quid philosophia naturalis? Unde philosophia naturalis secundum Hugonem in libro de Dyascolicon est disciplina omnis rerum naturalium [...].*

*'Quoniam autem' Iste liber qui intitulatur Physionomia Aristotelis prima sui divisione dividitur in octo capitula.*²⁵

Explicit: *reddit bonam memoriam et multas carnes.*

Manuscripts:

1. Aberystwyth, National Library of Wales, MS 2050B, ff. 42r-56r, 15th c.

11. Anonymus Basilensis, *Questiones super Aristotelis Physiognomiam*

Incipit: *Circa physonomiam Aristotilis summi philosophorum principis queritur primo: Utrum a physico vel medico possit per signa exteriora corporis humani sufficienter iudicare phisonomando mores et signa hominum? Et arguitur primo quod non, auctoritate Aristotelis secundo Ethicorum, qui dicit quod dispositiones nostre interiores permutantur in nobis per consuetudinem.*

Explicit: *Ad quintam: negatur maior quia magnitudo aurium non arguit bonam dispositionem [...], sed magis habundantiam materie melancholie, ita etcetera. Et hec est questio.*

²⁵ The *incipit* and *explicit* is taken from the online catalogue "Jordanus: An International Catalogue of Mediaeval Scientific Manuscripts".

Manuscripts:

1. † Basel, Universitätsbibliothek, F.VIII.15, ff. 26r-38r, year 1439

Text: This *questiones* commentary tackles several questions that are also found in Buridan's commentary (n.3). Although the questions are the same, the answers and elaborations are definitely written by another scholar. Since they sometimes use the same arguments and vocabulary, it is not unimaginable that this anonymous scholar was inspired by Buridan's commentary.

- (q.1) Utrum a physico vel medico possit per signa exteriora corporis humani sufficienter iudicare phisonomando mores et signa hominum.
- (q.2) Utrum anime sequuntur corpora aut utrum ad diversam dispositionem corporum in homine sequuntur diverse dispositiones animarum.
- (q.3) Utrum ex passionibus anime corpus immutetur.
- (q.4) Utrum modus phisonomandi per figuram sit bonus.
- (q.5) Utrum modus phisonomandi per mores faciei sit bonus.
- (q.6) Utrum pili molles significant timidum et duri fortem.
- (q.7) Utrum duo homines sive duo individua eiusdem speciei possunt esse eiusdem figure.
- (q.8) Utrum gravitas vocis sit signum fortitudinis et acuitas vocis sit signum timiditatis.
- (q.9) Utrum tarditas motus significat intellectum mollem timiditate vel debilitate et velocitas oppositum.
- (q.10) Utrum magnitudo frontis significat tarditatem et pigritiam motus.
- (q.11) Utrum ex magnitudine et eminentia oculorum iudicandum sit de stoliditate et fatuitate aut homines habentes magnos oculos et eminentes sint stulti et fatui.
- (q.12) Utrum parvitas oculorum et profunditas sit signum boni et actuti (*sic*) visus.
- (q.13) Utrum ex longitudine aurium iudicandum sit super stoliditate et stultitia.

12. Anonymus Brugensis, *Conclusiones de Phisonomia*

Incipit: *Primo ponentur conclusiones et exponentur ubi indigebunt, et notabilia, secundum modum consuetum in aliis. Aliqui dividunt istum librum in duos tractatus. In primo ostenditur quod phisonomia sit possibilis sive modus iudicandi per physonomiam et cum hoc diversos modos iudicandi per physonomiam.*

Explicit: *Vos autem potestis iudicare de partibus diversis secundum quod*

calide et frigide; et hoc scietis respiciendo si appropinquant ad orientem aut occidentem aut ad meridiem aut etc. Explicit de Phisonomia.

Manuscripts:

1. Brugge, Stedelijke Openbare Bibliotheek, Hs. 489, ff. 51r-55v, end of 13th c.

13. Anonymus Bruxellensis, *Circa phisonomiam Aristotelis*

Incipit: Circa phisonomiam Aristotelis queritur primo utrum per signa exteriora exteriora (sic) corporis humani de moribus et complexione hominum interiori possit a philosopho naturali evidens iudicium phisonomandi concludi. Et arguitur primo quod non, quia dispositio hominis interior potest per consuetudinem immutari.

Explicit: Ad rationes quidem dicendum: patet satis ex conclusionibus et notabilibus positis. Hec de questione ultima et per consequens de omnibus questionibus libelli phisonomie Aristotelis.

Manuscripts:

1. † Brussels, Koninklijke Bibliotheek/Bibliothèque Royale, Ms. 21856, ff. 118v-146v, 15th c.

Text: The questions asked in this manuscript of Brussels are identical to the questions of the commentary of John Buridan (n.3 of this inventory), except for the last one. The content of the answers and the phraseology is different, but might have been inspired by him (e.g. they quote the same sources or mention the same examples). Whereas this could have happened independently, it is more probable that this anonymous author based his text on Buridan's *questiones*.

(q.1) Utrum per signa exteriora exteriora corporis humani de moribus et complexione hominum interiori possit a philosopho naturali evidens iudicium phisonomandi concludi.

(q.2) Utrum anime sequuntur corpora sic scilicet quod ad diversitatem corporis vel corporis in specie humana sequantur diversitas anime vel animarum.

(q.3) Utrum ex passionibus anime inherentibus corpus immutetur sive patiatur.

(q.4) Utrum sit bonum iudicium in phisonomando per figuram.

(q.5) Utrum secundum mores apparentes in facie possumus modum phisonomandi iudicare.

(q.6) Utrum pili molles significant timidum et duri fortem.

(q.7) Utrum ex voce gravi sit iudicandum super fortem et audacem et ex voce acuta super timidum.

- (q.8) Utrum ex acuitate vocis in mulieribus sit iudicandum de earum timiditate.
- (q.9) Utrum ex motu tardo sit iudicandum super intellectum mollem debilitatem vel timiditatem et ex motu veloci vel acuto sit iudicandum super calidum audacem et fortem.
- (q.10) Utrum ex fronte magna in arte phisonomandi debemus iudicare super tardum et pigrum.
- (q.11) Utrum ex magnitudine oculorum et proeminentia ipsorum sit iudicandum supra stoliditatem sive fatuitatem et ex parvitate oculorum supra caliditatem et siccitatem.
- (q.12) Utrum ex parvitate et profunditate oculorum sit iudicandum super acuitatem visus et sit bonum signum.
- (q.13) Utrum ex magnitudine sive longitudine aurium sit iudicandum supra fatuitatem.
- (q.14) Utrum ex magnitudine foraminum narium sit iudicandum super irascibilitatem.
- (q.15) Utrum ex magnitudine oris sit iudicandum super homines voraces.
- (q.16) Utrum albedo sit signum timiditatis et nigredo melancolie et partitatis.

14. Anonymus Cracoviensis,

Questiones super de physionomia Aristotelis (ante 1451)

Incipit: Circa principium phizonomie Aristotelis queritur utrum ars phizonomie sit possibilis. Arguitur ex littera quod sic, quia philosophus tradidit nobis artem phisonomizandi et plures alii auctores sicut Avicenna, Rasis, Philemon.

Explicit: Dubitatur quare mulier semper incedit tecta. Dicitur, quod ideo, quia debet esse subiecta viro, sicut omnia alia animalia et entia debent esse subiecta Deo, cui debetur laus, honor et gratiarum actio per infinita secula seculorum. Amen.

Manuscripts:

1. Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 1903, ff. 207v-219v, 15th c.
2. † Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 2097, ff. 87v-102v, year 1451
3. † Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 2100, ff. 276v-286r, 15th c.

Text: This anonymous commentary is highly similar to the commentaries of Paulus de Worczyn (n.8) and Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega (n.9), although different in structure: some *contra* arguments are missing, sometimes with their corresponding answer, sometimes the answer is nevertheless given, or parts of the text are added at the end. From the vocabulary,

we can judge that the author followed Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega's version, rather than Paulus de Worczyn's treatise. The date of the manuscript Kraków 2097 gives us a *terminus ante quem* for the production of this treatise.

M. Garbaczowa, the editor of Nicolaus Tempelfeld de Brega's commentary, stated that there are, besides the two ascribed commentaries of Cracow, two anonymous treatises. She placed manuscript Kraków 2100 under a different category, bearing the title *Puncta super de physionomia*.²⁶ However, I could find no convincing arguments for treating them as two separate commentaries. There are hardly differences between them, except some small words that can be explained as a scribal error.

For the questions of this commentary, see n.8, Paulus de Worczyn. The exact set of questions is taken over.

15. Anonymus Cracoviensis, *Physiognomia*

Incipit: *Hominum genus arte et ratione vivit, ut dicit philosophus primo Metaphysice et hoc etiam confirmat Seneca in epistula ad Alexandrum.*

Explicit: *Si quis nascitur dum Saturnus dominatur; audax, urbanus, malus, antiquus, fur et avarus, perfidus, ellatus (sic), iracundus, nequitiosus.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Kraków, Biblioteka Jagiellońska, cod. 554, ff. 114v-130v, 15th c.

Text: This commentary, which is written in different handwritings, is written in combination with the translation by Bartholomew of Messina of pseudo-Aristotle's *Physiognomonica* (A.L. 1671): every part of the translation is followed by a part of the commentary.

16. Anonymus Erfordiensis (pseudo-Aegidius Romanus), *Super phizonomiam Aristotelis lectura*

Incipit: *'Quoniam autem et anime sequuntur corpora.' Circa istum librum sex inquiruntur: que intentio, que utilitas, quis modus procedendi, quis titulus, cui parti philosophie supponatur. Intentio est invenire artem per quam possumus coniecturare utrum aliquis operationes habeat naturaliter bonas sive viles.* (Ms. Erfurt)

Explicit: *Ex hec supponit auctor quod quedam phisonomie sunt referende ad dispositionem corporis, quedam vero in apparentem decentiam. Unde auctor infert quod inter omnia corpora quedam referuntur, quedam vero*

²⁶ GARBACZOWA, "Mikolaja Z Brzegu Komentarz", 128.

non referuntur in dispositionem corporis, sed in apparentem convenientiam. (Ms. Erfurt)

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 316, ff. 56v-66r, 14th c.
2. † Praha, Národní knihovna České republiky, Cod. IV.H.6 (cat. 770), ff. 81r-95r, 14th c.

Edition: Part of this text has been edited by C. LUNA, “Bemerkungen über die Handschriften der Werke des Aegidius Romanus in der Amplonianischen Bibliothek zu Erfurt”, in *Die Bibliotheca Amploniana. Ihre Bedeutung im Spannungsfeld von Aristotelismus, Nominalismus und Humanismus*, hrsg. v. A. SPEER (Miscellanea Mediaevalia 23), Berlin-New York 1995, 257-300 (edition on 293-98). The edition is based on the manuscript of Erfurt; the second manuscript of Praha is not mentioned in this study.

Text: This text has been ascribed by W. Schum to Giles of Rome.²⁷ However, he relied on a catalogue of 1412 and not on the manuscripts themselves, where no mention is made of Aegidius Romanus. Luna argues that there is no evidence to ascribe this treatise to Giles of Rome.

The manuscripts of Erfurt and Prague are not completely identical: sometimes a part of a sentence is left out or some words are added (especially at the beginning of the text), but it is clear that both manuscripts had the same source.

17. Anonymus Erfordiensis (pseudo-Aegidius Romanus), *Notabilia super de phisionomia*

Incipit: *‘Quicumque maius habent quod est ab umbilico.’ Hic phisionomizat Philosophus ex superiori ventre. Unde est intelligendum quod hic intelligit per ventrem locum qui est ab umbilico usque ad pectus qui vocatur venter superior.* (ed. LUNA, 298)

Explicit: *Minime etiam physionomizat ex partibus circa ventrem quia virtutes earum sunt deputate ad nutriendum, ideo ex eis non est physionomizandum, et ideo etcetera.* (Ms. Erfurt)

Colophon: *Explicit Deo gratias.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 316, ff. 66v-69r, 14th c.

²⁷ SCHUM, *Beschreibendes Verzeichniss*, 551.

Edition: Part of this text has been edited by C. LUNA, “Bemerkungen über die Handschriften der Werke des Aegidius Romanus”, 257-300 (edition on 298-300).

Text: Together with the previous text n.16 (pseudo-Aegidius Romanus’ *Super phisonomiam Aristotelis lectura*), this text was generally considered as one commentary. However, it has been demonstrated by Luna that the previous text covers the complete *Physiognomonica*, while these *Notabilia* only start from the middle of the *Physiognomonica*. Additionally, both texts have different explanation techniques and methods of working, which implies that they were written by a different author. It has also been classified as pseudo-Giles of Rome, since the structure and language of both commentaries differ from other commentaries of this scholar.²⁸

18. Anonymus Erfordiensis, *Scripta de phisonomia bona*

Incipit: ‘*Quoniam anime sequuntur corpora*’. *Iste liber dividitur in prohemium et in executionem, ibi ‘hii quidem igitur’. Primo in duas. Primo tangit artem phisonomandi, secundo concludit ipsam est possibilem, ibi ‘si autem hec vera’.*

Explicit: ‘*Que autem circa ventrem minime*’. *Quantum ad motum localem et ideo ex ipso ventre minime est physionomandum respectu aliorum membrorum. Explicit.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 2° 263, ff. 31r-34r, 14th c.

19. Anonymus Erfordiensis, *Expositio phisionomie Aristotelis*

Incipit: *Unde in productione capitur illa, nulla scientiarum est similis phisonomie. In De Vita et morte patitur nulla est similis huic que clarificat animam, sed sic est de scientia phisonomia.*

Explicit: *Ut pertractate quas optime Hali commentator eius in commentatis per totum secundum Tegni exponit.*

Colophon: *Explicit expositio brevis et utilis phisionomie Aristotelis.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 4° 186, ff. 117r-125r, 14th c.

²⁸ LUNA, “Bemerkungen über die Handschriften”, 264-65.

20. Anonymus Erfordiensis, *Commentum phisionomie*

Incipit: *Non est omnino felix, qui specie turpis est. Hanc propositionem scribit Aristoteles primo Rhetoricorum, in qua tangitur et primum est quod homo habens malam dispositionem seu figuram corporis, non est omnino felix.*

Explicit: *Sic phisionomandum ex dispositione frontis, oculorum, capitis et faciei et circa pectus et scapulas, circa ventrem et circa crura et alia loca pro nunc dicta sufficient.*

Colophon: *Explicit commentum phisionomie Aristotelis consumptum sub anno Domini 1397 in vigilia sancti Iohannis Baptiste hora nona cum prandium in studio Pragensi etcetera.* (Ms. Erfurt)

Manuscripts:

1. † Erfurt-Gotha, Universitäts- und Forschungsbibliothek, Dep. Erf., CA 2° 337a, ff. 40r-53v, year 1397
2. München, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 28559, ff. 71r-139r, 15th c.

21. Anonymus Florianensis,
Commentum super phisionomiam Aristotelis

Incipit: *'Nunc autem dicamus' Hic ostendit Aristoteles genera signorum ex quibus phisionomitur; dicit sive dicamus nunc ex quibus generibus signorum accipiuntur signa per que phisionomitur sive iudicatur inclinatio anime*

Explicit: *Dat signa, i.e. dat signa manifestissima et universaliter sic dicere illa (sic) loca prebent manifestissima signa in quibus fit superhabundantia plurime (sic). Explicit commentum super phisionomiam Aristotelis.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Sankt-Florian, Stiftsbibliothek, Cod. XI.355, ff. 141r-171v, 14th c.

Text: The first part of the commentary is missing and only starts with the words *'Nunc autem dicamus'* (Bekker 806a26-27).

22. Anonymus Florentinus (Radulphus Brito?),
Questiones in librum phisionomie Aristotelis

Incipit: *Hic incipiunt questiones libri de phisionomia. Circa librum de phisionomia queritur primo utrum de moribus naturalibus possit esse scientia. Secundo dico quod sic utrum ista scientia sit moralis vel naturalis et sic consequenter.*

Explicit: *Dico quod verum est si carnositas intelligatur propinque, sed intelligo per carnositatem sollidam nervositatem, sicut intelligit philosophus et sic non oportet. Et sic ad illud.*

Manuscripts:

1. † Firenze, Biblioteca Nazionale Centrale, Cod. Conv. Sopp. E.1.252, ff. 232v-242v, 14th c.

Text: According to Iacopo Costa, this Florence manuscript is a part of a broader work concerning unedited commentaries of Radulphus Brito. Indications of this can be found in the style of the text and the philosophical point of view.²⁹ Radulphus taught at the Faculty of Arts in Paris, and was active at the end of the thirteenth century. If this identification is correct, it would mean that this commentary is, together with William of Aragon's commentary (n.1), one of the first ones written on pseudo-Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*.

- (q.1) Utrum de moribus naturalibus possit esse scientia.
- (q.2) Utrum ista scientia que dicitur physonomia sit naturalis vel moralis.
- (q.3) Utrum anime secuntur corpora ita quod ad diversitatem corporum sequatur diversitas animarum.
- (q.4) Utrum corpora compatiuntur animabus.
- (q.5) Utrum contingat aliud animal esse generatum a natura quod habeat corpus et figuram unius animalis et animam alterius.
- (q.6) Utrum passiones circa quas est physiognomia et ex quibus physiognomare varientur secundum variationem temporum.
- (q.7) Utrum homines artifices et hoc quantum ad artes practicas activas et factivas et scientes et hoc quantum ad artes speculativas habentes possunt cognosci per signa physiognomandi.
- (q.8) Utrum duo individua eiusdem speciei possint esse eiusdem figure.
- (q.9) Utrum duo individua eiusdem speciei possint esse eiusdem dispositionis in moribus et figuris et coloribus et consimilibus.
- (q.10) Utrum caro dura naturaliter et habitus durus corporis significet hominem insensibilem, rudem et non ingeniosum.
- (q.11) Utrum homines septentrionales, id est habitantes versus polum, sint audaciores et habentes pilos duriores hominibus meridionalibus.
- (q.12) Utrum motus acuti significant homines subtiles et callidiores secundum mentem et prudentes.
- (q.13) Utrum vox acuta significet hominem timidum.
- (q.14) Utrum physiognomandum ex figuris.

²⁹ I thank Iacopo Costa for providing me with this information. See also S. EBBESEN, "Radulphus Brito on Memory and Dreams. An Edition", in *Cahiers de l'Institut du Moyen-Âge grec et latin* 85 (2016), 11-86, for further literature on the attribution of some commentaries in this Florentine manuscript to Radulphus Brito.

(q.15) Utrum masculus sit fortior fortitudine corporali ipsa femella et habens grossiora membra et etiam melior secundum omnes virtutes quia hoc dicit philosophus.

(q.16) Queritur de signis partium utrum habere magnas extremitates signum sit fortis.

(q.17) Utrum caro temperata mollis et dura significat bonam nativitatem.

(q.18) Utrum rectitudo corporis et latitudo eius sit signum iracundi vel irascibilis.

(q.19) Utrum lippitudo oculorum et color album sint signa hominis parvi et misericordis, et utrum signa opposita sint signa hominis nocosi et austeri.

(q.20) Utrum color album significat hominem luxuriosum.

(q.21) Queritur de amatore somni scilicet utrum habens superiora maiora sit sompnolentus.

(q.22) Utrum habentes superiora et maiora curviora et carnosiora significant bone memorie.

23. Anonymus Mediolanensis, *Commentarium*

Incipit: *'Quoniam autem anime sequuntur corpora'. Iste liber intytulatus de physonomia, id est de modo iudicandi dispositiones anime interiores per exteriora signa corporum*

Explicit: *de fortitudine et debilitate et postea de aliis signis facile etiam physionomare secundum electionem signorum que postea dicere*

Manuscripts:

1. † Milano, Biblioteca Ambrosiana, G.70 sup., ff. 13r-16r, year 1358

Text: This commentary does not cover the entire text and ends abruptly (in the chapter on the panther, Bekker reference 809b36). According to Agrimi, the text is preceded by three questions similar to those asked in Buridan's commentary.³⁰

24. Anonymus Monacensis, *Circa phisionomiam Aristotelis*

Incipit: *Circum phisionomiam Aristotelis sciendum est primo quod aliquis potest esse nobilis dupliciter: primo ex nobilitate parentum, quorum operationes virtuose in filiis sunt quasi lumen et exemplum; secundo ex bonitate operationis proprie.*

³⁰ Unfortunately, I was not able to see the images with the questions, only ff. 13r-16r were at my disposal. See AGRIMI, *Ingeniosia scientia nature*, 155 n.230, who states that the commentary is from Buridan. However, this manuscript does not offer the same texts as that of Buridan.

Explicit: *incorporea que per formam apparensivam virtute cuius dicitur apparentia habet (...) corpora et alterare ipsam. Ad questionem dicitur.*

Manuscripts:

1. † München, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 655, ff. 36r-42r, 15th c.

Text: This treatise stops abruptly and does not offer a commentary on the complete text of the *Physiognomonica*, but only on less than half (the last title mentioned is *ex figuris*, Bekker reference 806b28). This commentary is a combination of an *expositio* and *questiones*.

- (q.1) Utrum nobilior ex parentibus sit nobilior quam nobilis ex proprie operationum bonitate.
- (q.2) Utrum anime sequuntur corpora.
- (q.3) Utrum anime passibiles sunt a motibus corporum.
- (q.4) Utrum corpus patitur ab anima.
- (q.5) Utrum species intelligibiles habeant virtuti movendi corpus.

25. Anonymus Monacensis, *Expositio*

Incipit: *'Quoniam et anime sequuntur'. Iste liber cuius subiectum ponit corpus humanum ad mores et consuetudines relatum, dividitur in duas partes principales, secundum duos tractatus speciales. Primus tractatus est de modo phisionomizandi historialiter*

Explicit: *Quod principalia membra sunt inspicienda. Et nota quod auctor ostendit physionomia non tantum unum signum precipue est inspiciendum, sed multa. Et sic finis physionomie Aristotelis.*

Manuscripts:

1. † München, Bayerische Staatsbibliothek, Clm 19668, ff. 3r-12r, 14th-15th c.

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Abstract: Pseudo-Aristotle's *Physiognomonica* is one of the main authoritative texts in the field of ancient and medieval physiognomy. After its thirteenth century translation into Latin by Bartholomew of Messina, the treatise was widely diffused across Europe. Nevertheless, its medieval reception and use remains largely unexplored. The present paper aims to fill this gap and offers a new inventory of all the medieval commentaries written on pseudo-Aristotle's *Physiognomonica*. The newly discovered material allows us to demonstrate that this physiognomic text was more widely read and commented upon than was previously accepted, which inevitably changes the picture of medieval physiognomy in general.

Keywords: Physiognomonica – inventory – medieval commentaries.

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